Flagship portfolio project · Simulated case study

EMEA CUSTOMER EXPERIENCE & CUSTOMER SUCCESS TRANSFORMATION

PROJECT CATEGORY
Customer Experience | Customer Success | Business Transformation | Project Management

ORGANISATION
NEXORA Technologies (Fictional Organisation)

INDUSTRY
Technology / Software as a Service (SaaS)

GEOGRAPHICAL SCOPE
Europe, Middle East and Africa (EMEA)

PROJECT DURATION
16 Weeks (Simulated)

PROJECT ROLE
Customer Experience & Transformation Project Lead

METHODOLOGY
Hybrid Project Management (Agile, Scrum and Waterfall)

TOOLS
HubSpot CRM, Microsoft Excel, Power BI, Jira, Miro and Microsoft Project.

1 Executive Summary

Customer experience and customer retention are critical factors influencing the long-term success of technology organisations.

This project explores the design of a comprehensive Customer Experience and Customer Success Transformation Programme for NEXORA Technologies, a fictional multinational SaaS organisation operating across Europe, the Middle East and Africa.

The organisation faces several business challenges, including declining customer satisfaction, inconsistent customer support, inefficient onboarding processes, fragmented customer information and increasing subscription cancellations.

The project proposes an integrated transformation strategy to address these challenges through improved customer journey management, CRM implementation, customer success operations, process optimisation and performance monitoring.

A hybrid project management approach combines structured project governance with Agile delivery practices to ensure that proposed improvements are developed, tested and evaluated systematically.

The ultimate objective is to establish a consistent, measurable and customer-centric operating model across the organisation’s EMEA operations.

2 Business Background

About the organisation

NEXORA Technologies is a fictional multinational technology company providing cloud-based business management solutions to organisations across EMEA.

Simulated organisational profile:

- Headquarters: London, United Kingdom.
- Geographical presence: 12 EMEA countries.
- Employees: 850.
- Business customers: 25,000.
- Business model: Monthly and annual subscriptions.
- Customer support: Multiple regional support teams.

As the organisation expands internationally, maintaining consistent customer experiences becomes increasingly challenging.

Identified business challenges

An initial simulated business assessment identified the following concerns:

1. Inconsistent customer service across geographical regions.
2. Delays in responding to customer enquiries.
3. Complicated customer onboarding processes.
4. Limited visibility of customer interactions.
5. Fragmented customer information and communication channels.
6. Increasing customer dissatisfaction.
7. Inadequate customer retention strategies.
8. Limited performance reporting and customer analytics.
9. Inefficient complaint management and escalation procedures.
10. Inconsistent communication between customer-facing departments.

These challenges indicate a need for a coordinated customer experience transformation programme.

3 Project Objectives

The project establishes the following proposed objectives:

- Improve customer satisfaction and service quality.
- Standardise customer experience processes across EMEA.
- Develop a structured customer onboarding framework.
- Introduce a centralised CRM strategy.
- Improve complaint handling and resolution procedures.
- Establish proactive customer retention mechanisms.
- Improve communication between customer-facing departments.
- Develop measurable customer success KPIs.
- Improve operational efficiency through process optimisation.
- Establish a continuous improvement framework.

4 Project Scope

In scope

- Customer research and feedback analysis.
- Customer journey mapping.
- Customer segmentation.
- Customer onboarding improvements.
- CRM implementation planning.
- Customer support workflow optimisation.
- Customer success strategy development.
- Customer retention and churn prevention.
- KPI dashboard development.
- Stakeholder engagement.
- Employee training and change management.
- Risk and compliance considerations.
- Project monitoring and evaluation.

Out of scope

- Development of a new SaaS product.
- Replacement of the organisation's entire technology infrastructure.
- Actual deployment across all 12 countries.
- Changes to existing subscription pricing.
- Recruitment of permanent regional employees.

5 Customer Research & Discovery

The discovery phase focuses on understanding customer expectations, identifying service delivery gaps and evaluating existing processes.

Research methods

The proposed research approach includes:

- Customer satisfaction surveys.
- Voice of Customer (VoC) analysis.
- Customer interviews.
- Complaint trend analysis.
- Customer feedback categorisation.
- Customer journey analysis.
- Internal stakeholder consultations.
- Competitor benchmarking.

Customer segmentation

Customers are divided into four proposed segments:

Segment	Characteristics	Engagement strategy
New customers	Recently subscribed	Structured onboarding
Active customers	Regular product users	Engagement and education
At-risk customers	Declining engagement	Proactive intervention
High-value customers	Strategic business accounts	Dedicated relationship management

Customer personas

Three representative personas are developed:

Persona 1: The New Customer

Needs clear onboarding instructions, responsive support and assistance understanding the platform.

Persona 2: The Business Administrator

Needs reliable service delivery, efficient complaint resolution and visibility of account activity.

Persona 3: The At-Risk Customer

Experiences recurring service frustrations and requires proactive engagement and personalised support.

6 Customer Journey Mapping

The project examines the complete customer lifecycle.

Customer stage	Potential challenge	Proposed improvement
Awareness	Limited understanding of services	Clearer product information
Consideration	Unclear service benefits	Improved communication
Acquisition	Complicated registration	Simplified registration
Onboarding	Insufficient guidance	Structured onboarding
Adoption	Low product engagement	Customer education
Engagement	Inconsistent communication	Personalised engagement
Support	Delayed responses	Centralised ticket management
Retention	Limited follow-up	Proactive retention strategy
Advocacy	Limited feedback opportunities	Customer feedback programmes

Future-state customer experience

The proposed future-state journey introduces:

- Automated onboarding communications.
- Personalised customer engagement.
- Centralised customer interaction records.
- Consistent service standards.

- Structured complaint escalation.
- Proactive customer retention.
- Regular feedback collection.

7 Customer Success Management Strategy

A structured Customer Success Framework is proposed to improve customer engagement and long-term retention.

Customer onboarding

The proposed onboarding process includes:

1. Welcome communication.
2. Account activation.
3. Product introduction.
4. Guided platform demonstration.
5. Customer training.
6. Initial usage assessment.
7. Onboarding completion confirmation.

Customer Health Score

A proposed customer health scoring model combines:

Indicator	Weight
Product engagement	30%
Support history	25%
Customer satisfaction	25%
Account activity	20%

Customers are categorised as:

- Healthy: 80–100.
- Needs attention: 50–79.
- At risk: Below 50.

The model enables Customer Success teams to prioritise accounts requiring additional support.

Customer retention strategy

Proposed initiatives include:

- Proactive customer check-ins.
- Renewal reminders.
- Customer feedback reviews.
- Personalised engagement campaigns.
- Early identification of churn indicators.

- Escalation of unresolved customer concerns.

8 CRM Implementation Strategy

A centralised Customer Relationship Management system is proposed to improve customer information management and service coordination.

Proposed platform: HubSpot CRM.

Key CRM capabilities

- Customer database management.
- Customer interaction tracking.
- Support ticket management.
- Customer segmentation.
- Communication history.
- Automated follow-up reminders.
- Customer feedback records.
- Customer lifecycle monitoring.

Proposed CRM workflow

Customer enquiry → Ticket creation → Categorisation → Assignment → Resolution → Customer confirmation → Feedback collection → Closure.

CRM implementation stages

1. Requirements gathering.
2. System configuration planning.
3. Customer data structure design.
4. Workflow development.
5. User acceptance testing.
6. Employee training.
7. Implementation readiness assessment.
8. Post-implementation monitoring.

9 Agile, Scrum & Project Delivery

A hybrid project management methodology is adopted.

Waterfall principles provide structured governance, project approval and milestone control.

Agile practices support iterative development, customer feedback and continuous improvement.

Scrum implementation

The CRM development and customer onboarding workstreams are organised into four proposed two-week sprints.

Sprint	Focus	Expected deliverable
Sprint 1	Requirements and customer needs	Product backlog
Sprint 2	CRM structure and ticket workflows	CRM prototype
Sprint 3	Automated communications	Workflow prototype
Sprint 4	Testing and refinement	Tested solution

Scrum artefacts and ceremonies

- Product backlog.
- Sprint backlog.
- User stories.
- Sprint planning.
- Daily stand-up meetings.
- Sprint reviews.
- Sprint retrospectives.
- Definition of Done.

Example user story:

“As a customer, I want to receive an automated acknowledgement when submitting a support request so that I know my enquiry has been registered.”

Acceptance criteria:

- An acknowledgement is generated.
- A unique ticket reference is provided.
- The customer receives an expected response timeframe.
- The support team can track the request.

10 Lean Six Sigma & Process Improvement

Lean Six Sigma principles are incorporated to identify inefficiencies and improve customer support operations.

The DMAIC methodology is applied to the complaint resolution process.

DMAIC framework

Define: Identify delays and inefficiencies in complaint handling.

Measure: Establish baseline response and resolution times.

Analyse: Investigate bottlenecks and identify root causes.

Improve: Propose automated ticket allocation, clearer ownership and escalation procedures.

Control: Monitor performance through regular KPI reporting.

Additional process improvement techniques

- Five Whys analysis.

- Fishbone diagrams.
- Pareto analysis.
- SIPOC process mapping.
- PDCA continuous improvement cycle.
- Value stream mapping.

These techniques support structured investigation and sustainable process improvement.

11 Customer Support & Service Quality

A standardised customer support operating model is proposed across EMEA.

Key components

- Service Level Agreements (SLAs).
- Complaint management procedures.
- Escalation matrix.
- First Contact Resolution (FCR).
- Customer interaction quality assurance.
- Support knowledge base.
- Customer communication standards.
- Service performance reviews.

Proposed escalation framework

Level	Issue	Responsible team
Level 1	General enquiries	Customer Support
Level 2	Complex service issues	Senior Support
Level 3	Critical technical issues	Technical Support
Level 4	Strategic or major incidents	Management

12 Data Analytics & Performance Management

A performance measurement framework is developed to monitor customer experience and operational effectiveness.

Proposed KPI framework

KPI	Illustrative baseline	Proposed target
Customer Satisfaction (CSAT)	68%	85%
Net Promoter Score (NPS)	+12	+35
Customer Retention Rate	72%	85%
First Response Time	24 hours	4 hours
First Contact Resolution	55%	80%
Onboarding Completion	60%	90%
Monthly Customer Churn	8%	4%

These figures represent simulated planning assumptions and proposed targets, not verified company performance.

Dashboard development

The proposed dashboard uses Microsoft Excel and Power BI.

It includes:

- Customer satisfaction trends.
- Regional performance comparisons.
- Complaint volumes.
- Response and resolution times.
- Customer retention.
- Churn analysis.
- Onboarding completion.
- Customer health scores.

The dashboard provides management with a structured view of customer performance.

13 Stakeholder Management

Effective stakeholder engagement is essential to delivering a transformation programme across multiple regions.

Key stakeholders

- Executive leadership.
- Regional management.
- Customer Success teams.
- Customer Support teams.
- Sales and Marketing.
- IT and CRM administrators.
- Information Security.

- Customers.
- External technology providers.

Stakeholder management approach

A Power-Interest Grid is used to classify stakeholders according to their influence and interest.

A RACI matrix is proposed to establish responsibilities.

Activity	Project Lead	IT	Customer Success	Management
Project planning	A/R	C	C	I
CRM configuration	C	A/R	C	I
Customer journey mapping	A/R	C	R	I
Employee training	A	C	R	I
Project approval	R	C	C	A

R = Responsible, A = Accountable, C = Consulted, I = Informed.

14 Change Management

The ADKAR change management model is incorporated to support employee adoption of the proposed CRM and operational improvements.

ADKAR stage	Proposed activity
Awareness	Explain why transformation is necessary
Desire	Communicate employee benefits
Knowledge	Provide system and process training
Ability	Conduct practical exercises
Reinforcement	Monitor adoption and provide ongoing support

Employee feedback and training assessments are included in the proposed change management approach.

15 Risk Management & Data Governance

A RAID framework is established to monitor risks, assumptions, issues and dependencies.

Key project risks

Risk	Potential impact	Mitigation
CRM integration difficulties	Implementation delays	Early technical assessment
Employee resistance	Low system adoption	Training and communication
Inaccurate customer data	Poor customer records	Data validation
Data protection concerns	Compliance exposure	Privacy and security reviews
Budget overruns	Financial pressure	Cost monitoring
Regional inconsistency	Uneven service quality	Standardised processes

Data protection considerations

The proposed CRM framework considers:

- UK GDPR and applicable regional data protection requirements.
- Data minimisation.
- Role-based access controls.
- Customer data accuracy.
- Data retention policies.
- Appropriate handling of customer information.
- Privacy and security assessments.

16 Budget & Resource Management

An illustrative project budget is developed to evaluate the financial requirements of the proposed transformation.

Budget category	Estimated cost
CRM configuration and implementation	£12,000
Employee training	£5,000
Data migration and validation	£4,000
Analytics and reporting	£3,000
Project management resources	£8,000
Contingency	£3,000
Total	£35,000

These are hypothetical planning estimates, not supplier quotations.

Resource management includes project coordination, CRM administration, customer success representatives, IT support and regional stakeholder participation.

17 Project Timeline

The proposed programme runs for 16 weeks.

Phase	Timeline
Project initiation	Weeks 1–2
Research and discovery	Weeks 3–4
Customer journey and strategy design	Weeks 5–6
CRM planning and configuration	Weeks 7–10
Process optimisation	Weeks 11–12
Training and testing	Weeks 13–14
Evaluation and closure	Weeks 15–16

Project progress is monitored through milestone reviews, status reporting and stakeholder meetings.

18 Continuous Improvement

The PDCA cycle is incorporated to ensure improvements remain sustainable.

- Plan: Identify service improvement opportunities.
- Do: Implement proposed changes.
- Check: Evaluate performance against KPIs.
- Act: Standardise successful improvements and address remaining gaps.

This establishes a continuous improvement approach rather than treating customer experience transformation as a one-time initiative.

19 Expected Business Outcomes

If successfully implemented and adopted, the proposed transformation is expected to deliver:

Improved customer satisfaction: More consistent communication and responsive customer support.

Improved retention: Earlier identification of customers at risk of cancelling.

Operational efficiency: Reduced manual administration and clearer support workflows.

Better customer visibility: Centralised customer information and interaction histories.

Improved decision-making: More reliable performance reporting and customer analytics.

Consistent regional operations: Standardised customer experience practices across EMEA.

Stronger employee capability: Improved training, communication and CRM adoption.

No actual business improvement results are claimed because this is a simulated portfolio project.

20 Project Closure & Evaluation

The final project stage evaluates readiness, deliverable completion and expected business benefits.

The proposed closure activities include:

- Review of project objectives.
- Deliverable acceptance.
- KPI baseline and target review.
- Risk and issue assessment.
- Lessons learned documentation.
- Stakeholder feedback.
- Benefits realisation planning.
- Recommendations for future improvements.

A post-implementation review is proposed after 30, 60 and 90 days to assess whether the changes are producing measurable benefits.

21 Professional Skills Demonstrated

This project demonstrates the application of knowledge across several professional disciplines.

Customer Experience Management

- Customer journey mapping.
- Voice of Customer analysis.
- Customer satisfaction.
- Complaint management.
- Service quality improvement.

Customer Success Management

- Customer onboarding.
- Customer engagement.
- Customer retention.
- Churn prevention.
- Customer health scoring.

Project Management

- Project initiation and planning.
- Agile and Scrum.
- Stakeholder management.
- Project governance.
- Risk management.
- Resource and budget planning.

Business Process Improvement

- Lean Six Sigma.
- DMAIC.
- Root cause analysis.
- SIPOC.
- PDCA.

Technology & Analytics

- CRM strategy.
- HubSpot.
- Microsoft Excel.
- Power BI.
- Jira.
- Customer analytics.

Change & People Management

- ADKAR.
- Employee engagement.
- Training and development.
- Communication planning.
- Performance monitoring.

22 Personal Reflection

This project provided an opportunity to explore how customer experience, customer success and project management intersect within a multinational technology organisation.

It strengthened my understanding of customer journey management, CRM strategy, stakeholder engagement, operational performance and continuous improvement.

An important learning outcome was recognising that successful customer experience management extends beyond resolving individual complaints. It requires an integrated approach involving people, processes, technology and measurable business objectives.

The project also allowed me to explore how Agile delivery, Lean Six Sigma and structured project governance can complement one another when addressing complex organisational challenges.

My key takeaway: Sustainable customer success is achieved when organisations understand their customers, empower their employees and continuously improve the processes supporting the customer journey.

Project disclaimer

NEXORA Technologies is a fictional organisation created for educational and professional portfolio purposes. This is an independently developed simulated business transformation case study.

Organisational data, customer metrics, project costs, timelines and proposed outcomes are illustrative assumptions rather than verified business results. The project demonstrates proposed methodologies and planning approaches, not a completed commercial CRM implementation.